06-21 第一篇

The Evolution of Maps

People have used maps for thousands of years to find their way and understand the world. The earliest maps were drawn on clay tablets（泥板）or carved into stone. Over time, mapmaking has changed greatly—from paper maps to digital maps on our phones. [1] In other words, maps have always helped humans explore and organize space, but the way we make and use them has never stopped improving. Today, maps can show real-time traffic, satellite images, and even 3D views of cities.

In ancient times, maps were mainly used for trade and travel. [2] For example, traders needed maps to find safe routes between cities; explorers drew coastlines and islands as they discovered new lands. Early maps were often not very accurate because people had limited tools and knowledge. Still, these maps were valuable—they showed where rivers, mountains, and settlements were. Maps also helped rulers plan battles and manage their kingdoms. Without maps, long journeys would have been much harder and more dangerous.

The invention of the compass and improved measuring tools led to more accurate maps. [3] Sailors and explorers could finally record coastlines, distances, and directions with greater precision. In the 15th and 16th centuries, European explorers created maps of the Americas, Africa, and Asia. By the 19th century, many countries had detailed maps of their land, including mountains, rivers, and roads. Mapmaking became a science, and people began to use agreed symbols and scales so that anyone could read a map.

In the 20th century, air travel and satellites changed mapmaking again. [4] Photos taken from planes and satellites gave us a "bird's eye view" of the Earth. This made it possible to map large areas quickly and update maps when the landscape changed. Then computers and the Internet arrived—today we can view maps on phones and computers, get directions in seconds, and see live traffic. Maps are no longer just paper; they are part of our daily digital life.

[5] The next time you open a map on your phone, remember that you are using a technology with a history of thousands of years—and it is still evolving.

选项

A. In other words, maps have always helped humans explore and organize space, but the way we make and use them has never stopped improving. B. For example, traders needed maps to find safe routes, and explorers drew coastlines as they discovered new lands. C. With better tools, sailors and explorers could record coastlines, distances, and directions much more accurately. D. Photos from planes and satellites gave a clear view

from above, making large-scale mapping and updates easier. E. From clay tablets to smartphones, maps have grown from simple sketches into tools that help billions navigate the world. F. Today, many students use online maps to do their geography homework.

答案键（Answer Key）

[1] A [2] B [3] C [4] D [5] E

深度解析

- **[1] A**：
  - **线索**：概括地图的历史与演变趋势。空前描述"People used maps thousands of years...find way, understand world...earliest on clay tablets, carved stone...Over time mapmaking changed greatly—paper to digital on phones"，空后说明"maps have always helped humans explore and organize space...way we make and use them has never stopped improving...Today maps show real-time traffic, satellite images, 3D views"。A选项"In other words, maps have always helped humans explore and organize space, but the way we make and use them has never stopped improving"（换言之，地图始终帮助人类探索和组织空间，但我们制作和使用它们的方式从未停止改进）中"In other words"概括空前，"helped humans explore and organize space...never stopped improving"与空后表述精准呼应，衔接顺畅。
- **[2] B**：
  - **线索**：古代地图的用途——贸易、旅行、探险。空前提出"In ancient times, maps were mainly used for trade and travel"，空后详述"Traders needed maps to find safe routes between cities...explorers drew coastlines and islands as discovered new lands...often not accurate...limited tools and knowledge...valuable...rivers, mountains, settlements...rulers plan battles, manage kingdoms"。B选项"For example, traders needed maps to find safe routes, and explorers drew coastlines as they discovered new lands"（例如，商人需要地图寻找安全路线，探险家则在发现新大陆时绘制海岸线）中"For example"引出具体用途，"traders...safe routes...explorers...coastlines"与空后内容完美对应，逻辑紧密。
- **[3] C**：
  - **线索**：罗盘与测量工具带来更精确的地图制作。空前提出"The invention of the compass and improved measuring tools led to more accurate maps"，空后列举"Sailors and explorers could finally record coastlines, distances, directions with greater precision...15th—16th centuries European explorers created maps of Americas, Africa, Asia...19th century detailed maps...symbols and scales"。

C选项"With better tools, sailors and explorers could record coastlines, distances, and directions much more accurately"（有了更好的工具，水手和探险家能更准确地记录海岸线、距离和方向）中"better tools"对应空前 compass、measuring tools，"record coastlines, distances, directions...accurately"与空后 record...greater precision 精准对应，衔接自然。

- [4] D：
  - **线索**：飞机与卫星摄影对地图制作的革新。空前提出"In the 20th century, air travel and satellites changed mapmaking again"，空后描述"Photos from planes and satellites gave us bird's eye view of Earth...possible to map large areas quickly and update when landscape changed...computers, Internet...maps on phones, directions in seconds, live traffic"。D选项"Photos from planes and satellites gave a clear view from above, making large-scale mapping and updates easier"（飞机和卫星拍摄的照片提供了自上而下的清晰视角，使大范围测绘和更新变得更容易）中"Photos from planes and satellites...view from above...large-scale mapping and updates"与空后 bird's eye view、map large areas quickly、update 完美对应，衔接得当。
- [5] E：
  - **线索**：全文收束与地图从古至今的演变总结。空[5]位于结尾段段首，空后为"The next time you open a map on your phone, remember that you are using a technology with a history of thousands of years—and it is still evolving"。E选项"From clay tablets to smartphones, maps have grown from simple sketches into tools that help billions navigate the world"（从泥板到智能手机，地图已从简单的草图发展为帮助数十亿人导航世界的工具）以总结性开句收束全文，"From clay tablets to smartphones"呼应前文历史演变，"simple sketches...tools...billions navigate"概括前文内容，与空后"technology with history...still evolving"形成自然衔接，收束精准。
- **干扰项分析**：
  - **F. Today, many students use online maps to do their geography homework.**：涉及学生用在线地图做作业，易被误填[1]或[4]。但F以"Today"引出具体使用场景，而空[1]讨论的是地图的总体历史与演变趋势，F的"students...homework"属于个别用途，与"maps have always helped...never stopped improving"的宏观论述焦点不同；空[4]讨论20世纪航空、卫星、计算机对地图制作的技术革新，F的作业场景与"planes, satellites, bird's eye view, digital"的技术论述层次不符。F属"主题相关但论述层次错位"型干扰。